

Presentation and Interview

Format

Interviews are carried out by two staff members, one of whom is the supervisor (or assessing co-supervisor) and the other an independent assessor (who will also have marked your report). In some cases, a third member of staff, e.g., a supervising post-doctoral research assistant, may be present at the interview. The mark for your Presentation and Interview is awarded by your independent assessor.

The interview will consist of three parts:

1. a presentation with slides,
2. questions from the interviewers,
3. and verbal feedback from the interviewers.

Project pairs are interviewed together. Their joint presentation should last 15 minutes in total, and the interview may take up to 45 minutes (1 hour in total). Where a student has worked alone, their presentation should last 10 minutes, and the interview may take up to 35 minutes (45 minutes in total).

The interviews are part of the examination process, and late arrival is not acceptable. If you are delayed for reasons outside your control, you must inform the student support office by phone in time to allow alternative arrangements to be made.

Interview schedule and bookings

Interviews should take place during the exam periods and within the dates indicated in the "Key dates".

It is the students' (or student's) responsibility to agree a date and time for the interview with their supervisor and assessor, and to book a suitable room. Interview rooms can be booked via [Resource Booker \(https://comms.manchester.ac.uk/uomstudentcomms/lz.aspx?p1=MyWUDU5MTEyNzAxUzA3NTEExOjQwMTkzQzUyM0JGRkEyOEZlQ0lxQUE0NTlyQ0Q5QTcx-&CC=&w=303172&cID=0&cValue=1\)](https://comms.manchester.ac.uk/uomstudentcomms/lz.aspx?p1=MyWUDU5MTEyNzAxUzA3NTEExOjQwMTkzQzUyM0JGRkEyOEZlQ0lxQUE0NTlyQ0Q5QTcx-&CC=&w=303172&cID=0&cValue=1). If you cannot find a room, you must contact [sons.programmes@manchester.ac.uk \(mailto:sons.programmes@manchester.ac.uk\)](mailto:sons.programmes@manchester.ac.uk) as soon as possible, providing your student ID number and specifying the date and time that the room is required.

It is your responsibility to check that the room has suitable display equipment to present your slides, that all necessary cables are in place, that you have all necessary adapters, and that you can connect your device. In case of problems, e.g., a broken monitor or a missing cable, you should notify [sons.programmes@manchester.ac.uk \(mailto:sons.programmes@manchester.ac.uk\)](mailto:sons.programmes@manchester.ac.uk) well in advance of the interview.

Presentations

Your presentation should summarise the project. It should give the main motivation, outline the current state-of-the-art, set up the research problem, highlight the key steps taken, present important results and their implications, and give concluding remarks, including potential future directions.

Think about the structure and logical narrative of your presentation, and ensure that your slides are clear and uncluttered. References should be included, and any graphics should be appropriately attributed.

Practise the delivery of your presentation more than once to ensure that your delivery is clear, confident, appropriately paced, and to time.